

## Week 7 / Thursday

Rick Wysocki

# Genre

- ▶ Type of communication
- ▶ Way of presenting information and/or arguments
- ▶ Audiences expectations
- ▶ Conventional
- ▶ Identified through examples

# Genres are Rhetorical

- ▶ Involve the communication of messages (often persuasive).
- ▶ Provide ways of addressing audiences.
- ▶ Linked to context, kairos, and audience expectations.

# Genre: Social Connections

- ▶ Social values
- ▶ Time period
- ▶ Observations and experiences

# Representation

Re-presentation: the presentation of life back to the audience.

## Question

Why is the representation of identities and communities important?

# Representation

*"By making some of the prominent and respectable characters of the world people of color, or by fleshing out the story arcs of a few female characters, the Rings of Power writers made the world more accessible to a broader audience. Now, a whole new generation of young people, at a greater number, can watch this series and see themselves in the characters. That is the purpose of diversity in film, so that the immersive, connecting effect of the characters is not reserved for only one group of people."*

– Gamerant: "Diversity in the Rings of Power"

# Representation

*“The key to all of this is that, whether demonising black characters, killing them off, or simply excluding them altogether, Western horror has until recently primarily been a white person’s story – and that’s not to mention the poor representation of Asian characters and their erasure in the various Hollywood remakes of Asian horror hits from The Ring to The Eye.”*

*– BBC: Candyman and Horror’s Dubious Reckoning with Racism*

*An Oklahoma-based radio station said it is now playing Beyoncé's new country single, "Texas Hold 'Em," after its initial move to not play the song drew quick criticism from fans over what they perceive to be narrow-mindedness. A fan said he emailed KYKC requesting the song and received the following response: "Hi — we do not play Beyoncé on KYKC as we are a country music station."*

## From Tyler, The Creator

*"I'm half-and-half on it," Tyler said when asked about winning the award. "On one side I'm just grateful that what I made could be acknowledged in a world like this. But also it sucks that whenever we—and I mean guys that look like me—do anything that's genre-bending or anything they always put it in a Rap or Urban category."*

# Genre and Inclusion

- ▶ Genres, their tropes and conventions, and audience responses say something about larger social ideas.
- ▶ Genres suggest tropes and conventions for representing identities back to readers/viewers.
- ▶ Genres can be said to be inclusive to the extent that their examples include a range of people's experiences, rather than focusing on a more limited set of identities/groups.
- ▶ Genres can be changed.